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Post Office Guide Part-I

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Post Office Guide Part-I

Chapter 1: General Postal Regulations and Services

1. Working Hours of Post Offices

Night Post Offices

The Circle Head, Regional Head, and Divisional Head are empowered to specify the working hours for post offices under their jurisdiction.

- **Public Business Hours:**
 - **Enquiries:** Available during the **entire working hours** of the office.
 - **Counter Services:** Booking/posting of items, insurance premiums, and money remittances (e.g., eMO, IPO) are available for **six hours**.
 - **Savings Bank:** Transactions are available for **six hours**.
- **Branch Post Offices:** Shall remain open for a maximum period of **five hours** in a day.

Extension of Hours (Night Post Offices)

The Head of Circle or Regional Head may authorize specific post offices to operate as 'Night Post Offices' to meet public demand or special circumstances.

- These offices transact specific business authorized by the Circle/Regional Head.
- They function on days and hours other than standard working days, including **Sundays and holidays**.

2. Mobile Post Offices

- **Purpose:** Intended to provide late posting facilities in different city areas according to a fixed schedule.

- **Restrictions:**

- They remain **closed** on **Sundays and Postal Holidays**.
- They do not accept **Insured** or **COD** (Cash on Delivery) articles.
- They do not book Money Orders (implied by exclusion lists in standard practice).

3. Business on Sundays and Holidays

Generally, all Post Offices and Mobile Post Offices remain closed on Sundays and Postal Holidays. However, specific exceptions exist:

- **Night Post Offices:** Remain open and transact authorized business.
- **RMS Offices:** Generally sell stamps/stationery and book registered articles during specified hours.
- **Letter Boxes:**
 - Street letter boxes are **not cleared** on these days.
 - Letters with the prescribed late fee (if applicable) can be posted in letter boxes at RMS offices, selected post offices, or RMS mail vans during specific hours.
 - **Franked Articles:** Machine franked articles **must not** be posted in letter boxes on these days.
- **Registered Newspapers:** Accepted at Press Sorting Offices, RMS offices, and Night Post Offices.

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** The Late Fee for posting has been **abolished** vide **GSR-912(E)** dated **29.12.2022**.

Chapter 2: Remotely Managed Franking System (RMFS)

1. Licensing and Identification

- **Authority:** The license is issued by the **Head of Postal Division**, Independent Gazetted Postmaster, or Directors of GPOs (Mumbai, Kolkata, New Delhi).
- **Validity:** The license is valid for **5 years**.
- **Categories:** Three types of licenses are available: (1) Individual, (2) Commercial, and (3) Departmental.
- **Fees:**
 - **New License:** Rs. 375/-.
 - **Renewal (Timely):** Rs. 375/- (Application must be made 1 month before expiry).
 - **Renewal (Expired License):** Rs. 475/-.
- **Processing Time:**
 - Issue of new license: **10 working days**.
 - Renewal of license: **5 working days**.
- **Cancellation:** If no renewal application is submitted, the license may be cancelled **3 months** after the expiry date.

2. Operational Rules

- **Digifrank Plus:** The brand name for the new RMFS facility by India Post.
- **Impression:** Consists of a Value Die and a License Die. The impression must be **blue** in color.

- **Posting Location:** Articles must be presented at the **Designated Post Office** (not below the status of a double-handed office).
 - Only **one office** is authorized for acceptance; no second office is permitted.
 - Franked articles posted in letter boxes will be treated as **unpaid articles**.
 - Articles bearing impressions of a **previous date** are not accepted.
- **Identifiers:**
 - **CRN (Customer Reference Number):** A unique number issued by the Licensing Authority (same as the License Number).
 - **License Identifier:** A unique machine number assigned by the OEM.

3. Recharge and Credit

- **First Recharge:** Minimum Rs. 2,000/-.
- **Subsequent Recharges:** Minimum **Rs. 1,000/-**, in multiples of Rs. 100/-.
- **Connectivity:** The machine must dial the specific Server daily (at **10:00 PM**) to sync data.
 - If the machine fails to dial the server for **30 days**, it is automatically blocked.
 - Unblocking requires dialing the server and uploading data (reversible process).

4. Rebates on Usage

Rebates are calculated based on the credit uploaded and consumption:

- **Standard Rebate:** 3% on the franked value, allowed at the time of credit upload.
 - *Condition:* Minimum consumption of Rs. 5,000/- is required.

- **Additional Rebate:** 2% allowed for presenting franked mail sorted **Pin-Code** wise.
- **Claim Procedure:** Rebates are claimed using form **ACG-17** at the first time of posting after a recharge.

5. Refunds

- **Erroneous Impressions:** Refund is granted for impressions made in error, less a **5% deduction** on face value.
 - *Condition:* Envelopes/wrappers must be surrendered, and the claim preferred within **1 month**.
- **Unused Postage Units:** Refunds for unused units are granted only upon **condemnation** or **discontinuation** of the machine.
 - *Time Limit:* Claim must be submitted within **3 months** of condemnation/discontinuation.
 - *Authority:* Head of Circle (HoC) or Head of Region (HoR).

6. Machine Maintenance & Records

- **Register of Repairs:** The licensee must preserve the 'Register of Repairs' for **2 years** from the date of the last entry.
- **Authorized OEMs:** The Department currently authorizes two Original Equipment Manufacturers for Franking Machines :
 1. M/s Quadient (formerly Neopost)
 2. M/s Pitney Bowes India Pvt. Ltd.

7. Blocking and Cancellation Logic

- **Reversible Block:** If the machine fails to dial the server for **30 days**, it is blocked. This is a **reversible process** (unlocked upon next successful dial-in) .
- **Non-Reversible Cancellation:** Once a meter is officially "cancelled," the process is **non-reversible**; that meter cannot be used for re-credit.

8. Advertising on Frank

- **Slogan Limit:** Not more than one slogan or advertisement is permitted on a single article.

Chapter 3: Prohibitions and Delivery Rules

1. Fictitious Stamps

The manufacture or use of fictitious stamps is strictly prohibited and is a punishable offense.

- **Statutory Provision:** Punishable under **Section 179** of the **Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023**.
- **Philatelic Illustrations:** Reproduction of stamps for philatelic publications is permitted only in **black**.
 - Color reproductions require prior permission from the **Secretary, Department of Posts**.
 - Reproductions must not be the same size as the original and must lack perforations.

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** The source text cites "Section 186"; however, **Section 179** of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), 2023 specifically corresponds to the prohibition of

fictitious stamps (formerly Section 263A of the IPC). Section 186 of BNS relates to obstructing public servants.

2. Defense Services Mail

- **Addressing:** Mail for defense personnel delivered via Army Post Offices (APO) must contain: **No., Rank, Name, and Unit.**
- **Care Of:** Must be addressed to **C/o 56 A.P.O.** or **C/o 99 A.P.O..**
- **Green Envelopes/Force Letters:** These are inland letter cards with prepaid postage under special arrangements. No postage due should be recovered from the addressee if they bear the date stamp of an "Army Post Office".

3. Delivery and Detention of Articles

- **Damaged Registered Articles:**
 - **Inland:** A notice is sent to the addressee to attend the Post Office within **7 days.**
 - **Foreign:** A notice is sent to take delivery (personally or via agent) within **15 days.**
- **Parcels:** A fully prepaid parcel (excluding COD/Poste Restante) is issued for delivery **twice.** If undelivered after two attempts, it is detained at the Post Office for delivery through the window.
- **Detention (Demurrage):**
 - Addressees can request retention of articles in the Post Office.
 - Maximum retention period: **7 days** from the date of receipt.

4. Identification Cards

- **Issuance:** Issued only by **Head Offices (HO).**
- **Validity:** **3 years** from the date of issue.

- **Fees:**
 - Application Fee: Rs. 20/-.
 - Processing Fee: Rs. 250/-.
 - *Total Cost: Rs. 270/-.*

5. Poste Restante

- **Purpose:** Intended for the convenience of strangers and travelers.
- **Maximum Usage:** A person may not use this service for more than **3 months**.
- **Detention Periods:**
 - General Articles: Kept for **15 days**.
 - Value Payable (VP) / COD Articles: Kept for **7 days**.

6. Validity of Instructions

- **Change of Address:** Written instructions for a change of address are valid for **3 months** only .
- **Delivery to Caretaker/Messengers:** Instructions authorizing delivery to persons other than the addressee (e.g., messengers) are treated as **lapsed after 3 years** unless renewed .

7. "All Up Scheme" & QMS

- **All Up Scheme:** All **First-Class Mails** (Letters, Letter Cards, Postcards) are given **free air transmission** within Indian limits.
- **Quick Mail Service (QMS):** Articles for this service should be posted in the **Special Letter Box** which is **Yellow Striped** and marked **QMS** .

8. Penalties on Letter Cards

- If a Letter Card exceeds the weight limit (**5 grams**) or infringes conditions, it is taxed as a **Letter**, and **double the deficiency** at the letter postage rate is recovered.

Chapter 4: Postal Article Classifications

The Department classifies postal articles into the following categories :

1. Letter
2. Letter Cards (Weight limit: **5 grams**)
3. Post Cards
4. Book Post
5. Literature for the Blind
6. Periodic Post
7. Registered Newspapers
8. Magazine Post
9. Parcel (India Post Parcel & Speed Post Parcel)
10. Gyan Post

Blind Literature Packets

- **Exemptions:** These packets are exempted from **Postage, Registration Fee, and Fee for Acknowledgement/attested copy of receipt.**
- **Transmission:** Free transmission is by **surface route only**. Airmail charges apply if sent by air.

Chapter 5: Registered Newspapers

1. Definition and Registration

- **Legal Definition:** Under the **Press and Registration of Periodicals Act, 2023**, a "Newspaper" is defined as a periodical of loose-folded sheets, printed on newsprint, published daily or at least once a week, containing current events or public news.

- **Registration Authority:** The newspaper must be registered in the office of the **Head of the Division** or **Independent Gazetted Postmasters** within whose jurisdiction it is published.
- **Application Process:** The application must be accompanied by:
 1. **Two copies** of the latest issue of the newspaper.
 2. A copy of the valid certificate of registration issued by the **Press Registrar General**.
- **Timeline:** Postal registration shall be granted within **30 days** from the receipt of the application.

2. Posting Conditions

- **Publication Details:**
 - The date of publication must be printed on the **first or last page**.
 - The name of the posting office must be printed mandatorily on the **back page, top left corner**.
 - The word "**Registered**" followed by the registration number assigned by the Head of Division must be printed on the first or last page.
- **Posting Schedule:** The newspaper must be posted on specified days (not exceeding **seven days**) as declared in the application.
 - If the posting date falls on a Sunday/Holiday, it can be posted on the **succeeding working day**.
 - Changes to dates require **two days' prior intimation** to the Postmaster.
- **Quantity:** A newspaper must be published and posted for at least **half of its issues** in a calendar year.

3. Renewal of Registration

- **Validity:** The first registration remains in force until **31st December** of the **third calendar year** following the year of effect. Subsequent renewals are valid for **three calendar years**.
- **Application Window:** Renewal applications must reach the authority at least **three months** before expiry (before **30th September**).
- **Fees:**
 - **Timely Renewal:** No fee.
 - **Late Fee (Oct 1 - Dec 31):** Rs. 50/-.
 - **Expired License (After Dec 31):** Rs. 100/-.
- **Processing:** Renewal must be completed within **15 days** of receipt of the application.

4. Posting Without Prepayment (WPP)

- **Eligibility:** Owners/publishers intending to post more than **500 copies** at a time may apply for a license to post without affixing postage stamps.
- **Authority:** Permission is granted by the **Head of Circle** or **Head of Region**.
- **Marking:** The license number must be printed with the words "Licensed to post without prepayment" or the prefix "**WPP**".
- **Security Deposit:** Equivalent to the total of **one month's postage**.
- **Billing Schedule:**
 - **16th of Month:** Bill for postings between **1st to 15th**.
 - **1st of Next Month:** Bill for postings between **16th to end of previous month**.

- **Payment Deadline:** Within 7 days of bill issuance.
- **Default:** If not paid within a **fortnight**, posting is stopped and the license is deemed cancelled.

5. Postage Rates for Registered Newspapers

A. Single Copy

- Weight not exceeding 50 grams: 25 paise.
- Weight 50 grams to 100 grams: 50 paise.
- Every additional 100 grams (or fraction): 20 paise.

B. Multiple Copies (Packet)

- Weight not exceeding 100 grams: 50 paise.
- Every additional 100 grams (or fraction): 20 paise.

5. Dispute Resolution

- **Authority:** If any dispute arises regarding the effect of the license or related matters, it must be referred to the **Member (Operations)**. Their decision is **final**.

6. Special Pricing Exemption

- **Government Publications:** The mandatory requirement to print the **price** on the newspaper is waived for newspapers published by **Ministries/Departments of the Government of India**.

Chapter 6: Official Mail and Special Services

1. Official Postal Articles

- **Unpaid/Insufficient:** Postage chargeable on delivery for "On Government Service" articles:
 - **Unpaid:** Charged at the **prepaid rate** (not double).
 - **Insufficiently Paid:** Charged the **deficiency** only.
- **Parcels:** Prepayment of postage on official parcels is **compulsory**.

2. Camp Bags

- **Eligibility:** Exclusive facility for the **President, Vice-President, Central Ministers, State Governors, and DG Posts**.
- **Availability:** Booked and delivered on all days, including **Sundays and Holidays**.

Tariff Structure :

Particulars	Parcel (Max 10 Kg)	Air Parcel	Letter Mail
Postage	Payable on 10 Kg Parcel	According to weight	No Charge
Incidental Charge	Rs. 16/-	Rs. 6/-	Nil
Registration	As applicable	As applicable	As applicable

Chapter 7: Money Remittance Services

1. Money Orders (MO)

- **Limits:** The maximum amount for a single Money Order is **Rs. 10,000/-**
 - **Aggregate Limit:** Total remittance to a single person in a month shall not exceed **Rs. 25,000/-**.

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** The maximum limit for a single eMO is currently **Rs. 10,000/-** vide administrative instructions, superseding the previous limit of **Rs. 5,000/-**.

- **Commission:** **Rs. 1/-** for every **Rs. 20/-** (or fraction thereof).
- **Exemptions:** No commission is charged for contributions to the **Prime Minister's Relief Fund, PM CARES Fund, or Chief Minister's Relief Fund**.
- **Void MO:** If a money order remains unpaid to the payee or remitter at the end of the **second month** following the month of issue, it is treated as **Void**.
- **Forfeiture:** If unpaid beyond **three years**, the amount is forfeited to the Government of India.

2. Indian Postal Orders (IPO)

- **Denominations & Commission :**
 - **Rs. 10** (Commission: **Rs. 1**)
 - **Rs. 20** (Commission: **Rs. 2**)
 - **Rs. 50** (Commission: **Rs. 5**)
 - **Rs. 100** (Commission: **Rs. 10**)
- **Broken Amounts:** Up to **4 postage stamps** (total value not exceeding **Rs. 9/-**) may be affixed to enhance value (except on **Rs. 100 IPOs**).

- **Validity:**

- **0-24 Months:** Encashed without second commission.
- **24-36 Months:** Encashed with a **second commission** paid in postage stamps affixed to the back.
- **> 36 Months:** Forfeited.

3. Money Order (MO) Handling

- **Redirection:** An MO can be redirected to a new address of the payee **free of charge** upon request.
- **Retention Period:**
 - An MO is retained for **7 days** from the date of presentation or the date sent out for payment.
 - If unpaid after 7 days, it is returned to the remitter immediately on the **first working day** following the expiry.
- **Death of Payee/Remitter:**
 - If Payee is dead: Amount returned to Remitter.
 - If Remitter is also dead: Amount paid to the **legal heir** of the remitter.

4. Indian Postal Orders (IPO) Restrictions

- **Payment Mode:** IPOs **cannot** be paid by cash across the counter. They must be paid through a **bank** or **Post Office Savings Bank (POSB)** account .
- **Crossing:** IPOs can be **crossed** like cheques (for account-payee security) .

Chapter 8: Philately

1. Historical Context

- **First Stamp (India):** The "Scinde Dawk" was released in **1852**, embossed on wax/paper with the East India Company's Merchant Mark.
- **First World Stamp:** The "Penny Black" (UK) was issued on **1st May 1840**.
- **Independent India:** The first stamp was issued on **21st November 1947**, depicting the Indian Flag and slogan "Jai Hind," valued at **3½ annas**.

2. Philatelic Deposit Account (PDA)

- **Domestic Account:** Minimum opening balance Rs. 200/-.
- **Foreign Account:** Minimum opening balance Rs. 1,000/-.
- **Handling Charge:** **2%** (Minimum **Rs. 5/-**) levied on transactions for foreign customers.

3. Stamp Policies

- **Commemorative Stamps:**
 - **Living Personalities:** No stamp shall be issued on a living personality.
 - **Posthumous:** Can be issued only **10 years** after death (Exception: Head of State on **1st death anniversary**).
 - **Institutions:** Issued only on **50th, 75th, 100th, 125th, or 150th** anniversaries.
 - **Mandatory Purchase:** Proponents must purchase a minimum of **1 lakh stamps** (or **Rs. 25 Lakh** worth if the headquarters is outside India).
- **Definitive Stamps:** Printed for day-to-day postal needs in unlimited quantities and are reprinted as needed.

Bureau vs. Counter

- **Philatelic Bureau:** Deals with **mail orders** and maintains **Deposit Accounts** (PDAs) .
- **Philatelic Counter:** Only for the **sale** of items. They **do not** provide special cancellations or handle deposit accounts .

Commemorative Stamp Lifecycle

- **Sales Window:** Sold at Bureaus for **12 months** from issue.
- **Unsold Stock:** After **6 months**, unsold commemorative stamps are released to **regular counters** (Definitive counters) to increase visibility and are treated like regular postage .

Definitions

- **Mint Stamps:** Defined strictly as "unused stamps **without any postmarks**" .
- **Cancellation Cachet:** A device impressed with a hand stamp to denote a special event (e.g., inaugural flights, expeditions) .

4. Promotion Schemes

A. Deen Dayal SPARSH Yojana

- **Objective:** Scholarship for Promotion of Aptitude & Research in Stamps as a Hobby.
- **Target:** Students in classes **VI to IX**.
- **Scholarship Amount:** **Rs. 6,000/- per annum** (disbursed as **Rs. 1,500/- per quarter**).
- **Selection:** Based on academic record (min **60%**, or **55%** for SC/ST) and a Philately Project/Quiz.
- **Scope:** **920 scholarships** Pan-India (Max **40 per Circle**).

B. Dhai Akhar Letter Writing Competition

- **Categories:** (1) Up to 18 Years, (2) Above 18 Years.
- **Formats:** Inland Letter Card (500 words) or Envelope (1000 words).
- **Prizes (National Level):**
 - First: **Rs. 50,000/-**
 - Second: **Rs. 25,000/-**
 - Third: **Rs. 10,000/-**

C. My Stamp

- **Cost:** Rs. 300/- per sheet.
- **Content:** Contains **12 stamps** of **Rs. 5/-** each (Total face value **Rs. 60/-**).
- **Corporate Discount:**
 - **10% discount:** Purchase of 2-100 sheets.
 - **20% discount:** Purchase of >100 sheets (allowed only on the additional sheets).
 - *Customized My Stamp (Corporate):* Minimum order **5,000 sheets**. Flat **20% discount** applies (Cost: **Rs. 12 Lakhs** for 5,000 sheets).

5. Customized My Stamp (CMS)

Definition: A personalized sheet of Postage Stamps wherein corporates, organizations, and institutions can get their customized sheets printed from India Post.

- **Customization:** Alongside customized themed stamps, the organization may opt for printing their logo or images of their organization/institute.

Corporate Requirements & Pricing

- **Minimum Order:** An Institute/Organization is required to get at least **5,000 sheets** printed. More can be ordered in multiples of **5,000**.
- **Discount:** A discount of **20%** on the total amount is permitted for corporate customers.
- **Advance Notice:** The Institute/Organisation must place the demand at least **two months in advance**.
- **Denomination:** Each stamp of CMS will be of the denomination of Rs. 5.
- **Write-up:** Ten lines of maximum **2 paragraphs** may be written on the theme.
- **Language Protocol:** For Non-Hindi States, the title/write-up will be written in **Regional, Hindi, and English** (Sequence: Regional first, then Hindi, then English).

Cost Calculation for Corporate Customers

Particulars	Details
Minimum Quantity	5,000 sheets
Cost per Sheet	Rs. 300/-
Total Cost (Pre-Discount)	Rs. 15,00,000/-
Total Payable (After 20% Discount)	Rs. 12,00,000/-

Departmental Distribution Quota

India Post will print 500 additional customized My Stamp Sheets (over and above the customer order) at its own cost for sale online and at bureaus¹⁰. The distribution is as follows:

S.No.	Distribution Channel	Quantity
1	ePost Office	300
2	Concerned Philately Bureau of Circle	100
3	National Philatelic Museum (NPM)	100

- **Release Date:** The date of delivery to the institute will be assumed as the date of release.
-

6. Philatelic Advisory Committee (PAC)

Composition of the Committee

- **Chairman:** Minister of Communications.
- **Co-Chairman/Vice Chairman:** Minister of State for Communications.
- **Official Members:** Appointed by Department of Posts (DoP), Department of Economic Affairs, and Ministry of Culture.
- **Non-Official Members:** Nominated from fields of Art and Culture, Music and Dance, plus **One Member** from Rajya Sabha and **One Member** from Lok Sabha.
- **Member Secretary:** DDG (Philately).

Scope of Work

1. Advice to the Government regarding the issue of Commemorative Postage Stamps.
2. Recommending proposals for inclusion in the **Annual Stamp Calendar**.
3. Recommendations of guidelines for the issue of commemorative postage stamps.

Operational Rules

- **Meeting Frequency:** The Committee meets **once a year**.
- **Tenure:** **Two years** from the date of notification for the constitution of the committee.

PART A: PRACTICE QUESTIONS

1. Under the Remotely Managed Franking System (RMFS), a rebate of 3% is allowed on the franked value provided the minimum consumption is:
(a) Rs. 1000/- (c) Rs. 5000/-
(b) Rs. 2000/- (d) Rs. 10,000/-
2. What is the minimum amount for subsequent recharges in the Remotely Managed Franking System (RMFS)?
(a) Rs. 2000/- (c) Rs. 500/-
(b) Rs. 1000/- (d) Rs. 100/-
3. The use of fictitious stamps is an offence punishable under which section of the Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023?
(a) Section 263A (c) Section 186
(b) Section 420 (d) Section 144
4. Postal articles for Defence Services personnel should be addressed to the care of:
(a) The nearest Head Post Office (c) The Ministry of Defence
(b) 56 A.P.O. or 99 A.P.O. (d) The District Magistrate
5. A Poste Restante article (excluding COD) is kept in the post office for a period not exceeding:
(a) 7 Days (c) 15 Days
(b) 10 Days (d) 30 Days
6. What is the application fee for an Identification Card issued by the Post Office?
(a) Rs. 9/- (c) Rs. 250/-
(b) Rs. 20/- (d) Rs. 100/-

7. Blind Literature packets are exempted from which of the following fees?
- (a) Postage only (c) Fee for Acknowledgement only
(b) Registration Fee only (d) All of the above
8. If an application for renewal of a registered newspaper is received after the date of expiry (after 31st December), what is the late fee charged?
- (a) Rs. 50/- (c) Rs. 200/-
(b) Rs. 100/- (d) Rs. 500/-
9. What is the postage rate for a single copy of a registered newspaper weighing more than 50 grams but not exceeding 100 grams?
- (a) 25 paise (c) 20 paise
(b) 50 paise (d) 1 Rupee
10. What is the Incidental Charge for a Camp Bag booked as a Parcel (10 Kg)?
- (a) Rs. 6/- (c) Rs. 16/-
(b) Rs. 10/- (d) Nil
11. What is the maximum amount for which a single Retail Money Order can be booked?
- (a) Rs. 5,000/- (c) Rs. 25,000/-
(b) Rs. 10,000/- (d) Rs. 50,000/-
12. A Money Order becomes void if it remains unpaid at the end of which month following the month of its issue?
- (a) First month (c) Sixth month
(b) Second month (d) Twelfth month

13. Indian Postal Orders presented for payment after 24 months but before 36 months from the month of issue are:

- (a) Forfeited
- (b) Paid without commission
- (c) Paid with second commission
- (d) Paid with double commission

14. On which date was the first stamp of Independent India issued?

- (a) 15 August 1947
- (b) 02 October 1947
- (c) 21 November 1947
- (d) 26 January 1950

15. What is the minimum amount required to open a Philatelic Deposit Account (PDA) for a foreigner?

- (a) Rs. 200/-
- (b) Rs. 500/-
- (c) Rs. 1000/-
- (d) Rs. 5000/-

16. According to philatelic guidelines, no postage stamp shall be issued on a living personality. This rule applies to:

- (a) Everyone without exception
- (b) Everyone except the President of India
- (c) Everyone except the Prime Minister
- (d) Everyone except Bharat Ratna awardees

17. Under the Deen Dayal SPARSH Yojana, what is the annual scholarship amount awarded to selected students?

- (a) Rs. 1500/-
- (b) Rs. 3000/-
- (c) Rs. 6000/-
- (d) Rs. 10,000/-

18. In the Dhari Akhar Letter Writing Competition, what is the word limit for the 'Envelope' category?

- (a) 500 words
- (b) 750 words
- (c) 1000 words
- (d) 1500 words

19. What is the cost of one 'My Stamp' sheet containing 12 stamps of Rs. 5/- each?
- (a) Rs. 60/- (c) Rs. 300/-
(b) Rs. 100/- (d) Rs. 500/-
20. For Customized My Stamp (CMS), what is the minimum mandatory order quantity for corporate customers?
- (a) 1000 sheets (c) 5000 sheets
(b) 2000 sheets (d) 10,000 sheets
21. What discount is offered on the purchase of more than 100 'My Stamp' sheetlets?
- (a) 5% (c) 15%
(b) 10% (d) 20%
22. Who serves as the Chairman of the Philatelic Advisory Committee?
- (a) Director General (Posts) (c) Minister of Communications
(b) Secretary (Posts) (d) Minister of State for Communications
23. For official 'On Government Service' articles that are unpaid, what is the postage chargeable on delivery?
- (a) Double the deficiency (c) The deficiency amount only
(b) The prepaid rate (d) No charge
24. What is the postage charge for Letter Mail sent via Camp Bag?
- (a) Rs. 16/- (c) Normal Letter Postage
(b) Rs. 6/- (d) Nil (Not charged as postage)

25. The security deposit for posting Registered Newspapers without Prepayment (WPP) is equivalent to:

- | | |
|-------------------------|----------------|
| (a) One month's postage | (c) Rs. 500/- |
| (b) Two months' postage | (d) Rs. 5000/- |



ANSWER KEY

Q.No	Answer	Q.No	Answer
1	(c)	14	(c)
2	(b)	15	(c)
3	(c)	16	(a)
4	(b)	17	(c)
5	(c)	18	(c)
6	(b)	19	(c)
7	(d)	20	(c)
8	(b)	21	(d)
9	(b)	22	(c)
10	(c)	23	(b)
11	(b)	24	(d)
12	(b)	25	(a)
13	(c)		

PART B: PRACTICE QUESTIONS (26-50)

26. Under the 'My Stamp' scheme, what discount is offered if a customer purchases more than 100 sheetlets?
- (a) 5% on total sheets (c) 20% on additional sheetlets over 100
(b) 10% on total sheets (d) 20% on the total number of sheetlets
27. For Customized My Stamp (CMS), what is the minimum mandatory order quantity for corporate customers?
- (a) 1,000 sheets (c) 5,000 sheets
(b) 2,000 sheets (d) 10,000 sheets
28. Under the Deen Dayal SPARSH Yojana, the scholarship is awarded to students of which standards?
- (a) Standard V to VIII (c) Standard VIII to X
(b) Standard VI to IX (d) Standard IX to XII
29. What is the prize amount for the First Prize winner at the National Level in the Dhai Akhar Letter Writing Competition?
- (a) Rs. 25,000/- (c) Rs. 1,00,000/-
(b) Rs. 50,000/- (d) Rs. 10,000/-
30. Which of the following statements regarding 'Camp Bags' is INCORRECT?
- (a) This facility is available only for high dignitaries like the President and Ministers. (c) Incidental charge for Letter Mail Camp Bag is Rs. 16/-.
(b) Camp bags are booked and delivered on all days including Sundays. (d) Registration charges are applicable as per norms.

31. What is the commission charged on a Money Order of Rs. 1,000/- contributed to the Prime Minister's Relief Fund?
- (a) Rs. 50/- (c) Rs. 5/-
(b) Rs. 20/- (d) No Commission
32. A Money Order that remains unpaid to the payee or remitter becomes 'Void' after which period?
- (a) End of the month of issue (c) End of the 6th month following the month of issue
(b) End of the 2nd month following the month of issue (d) After 1 year from the date of issue
33. What is the prescribed fee for processing an application for a Post Office Identity Card?
- (a) Rs. 20/- (c) Rs. 250/-
(b) Rs. 100/- (d) Rs. 9/-
34. In the case of unpaid official postal articles ("On Government Service"), the postage chargeable on delivery is:
- (a) Double the deficiency (c) No charge
(b) The prepaid rate (single deficiency) (d) Rs. 10/- penalty plus deficiency
35. What is the late fee for renewal of a Registered Newspaper if the application is received between 1st October and 31st December?
- (a) Rs. 20/- (c) Rs. 100/-
(b) Rs. 50/- (d) Rs. 500/-
36. If a Remotely Managed Franking Machine (RMFS) does not dial the server for a period of _____, it gets blocked.
- (a) 15 days (c) 60 days
(b) 30 days (d) 90 days

37. For a refund of erroneous franking impressions, the deduction made by the Department is:
- (a) 2% of face value (c) 5% of face value
(b) 3% of face value (d) 10% of face value
38. A 'Poste Restante' article (excluding COD) is kept in the Post Office for a maximum period of:
- (a) 7 days (c) 30 days
(b) 15 days (d) 3 months
39. If postage is insufficiently paid on an official postal article ("On Government Service"), what is charged on delivery?
- (a) The deficiency only (c) The deficiency plus Rs. 5 handling charge
(b) Double the deficiency (d) Nothing is charged
40. Mobile Post Offices are generally closed on:
- (a) Saturdays only (c) Gazetted Holidays only
(b) Sundays and Postal Holidays (d) They are never closed
41. According to Philatelic Guidelines, a commemorative stamp on a personality can be issued only after how many years of their death?
- (a) 1 year (c) 10 years
(b) 5 years (d) 25 years
42. The 'First Day Cover' (FDC) is usually issued along with which type of stamps?
- (a) Definitive Stamps (c) Revenue Stamps
(b) Commemorative / Special Stamps (d) Service Stamps

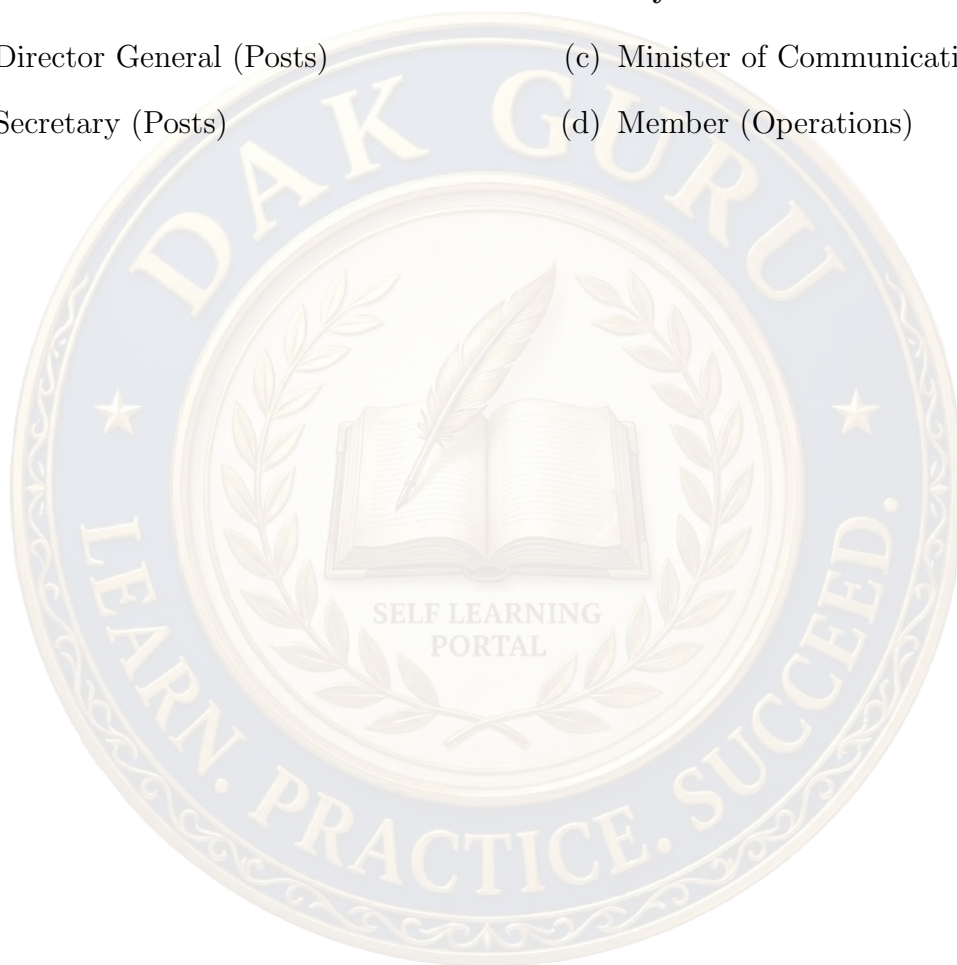
43. The security deposit required for posting newspapers under the 'Without Pre-payment of Postage' (WPP) system is equivalent to:
- (a) Two weeks' postage (c) Three months' postage
(b) One month's postage (d) Fixed amount of Rs. 5000/-
44. Which officer is empowered to specify the working hours of Night Post Offices?
- (a) Inspector of Posts (c) Director General (Posts)
(b) Head of Division / Regional Head / Circle Head (d) Postmaster General only
45. What is the commission for an Indian Postal Order (IPO) of Rs. 100 denomination?
- (a) Rs. 5/- (c) Rs. 20/-
(b) Rs. 10/- (d) Rs. 1/-
46. Use of fictitious stamps is an offence punishable under which Section of the Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023?
- (a) Section 263A (c) Section 186
(b) Section 420 (d) Section 144
47. What is the maximum weight limit for a single copy or packet of a Registered Newspaper?
- (a) 2 Kg (c) 10 Kg
(b) 5 Kg (d) 20 Kg
48. Blind Literature packets are exempted from postage, but if sent by air, what charges apply?
- (a) No charges (Airmail is also free) (c) Flat rate of Rs. 10/-
(b) Normal Airmail charges prescribed for packets (d) 50% of Airmail charges

49. Which of the following is NOT a condition for refund of unused postage units in a Franking Machine?

- | | |
|---|---|
| (a) Machine must be condemned or use discontinued. | (c) Refund is granted for used impressions made in error. |
| (b) Refund claim must be within 3 months of condemnation. | (d) Refund is for unused units remaining in the machine. |

50. Who is the Chairman of the Philatelic Advisory Committee?

- | | |
|------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| (a) Director General (Posts) | (c) Minister of Communications |
| (b) Secretary (Posts) | (d) Member (Operations) |



ANSWER KEY (PART B)

Q.No	Answer	Q.No	Answer
26	(c)	39	(a)
27	(c)	40	(b)
28	(b)	41	(c)
29	(b)	42	(b)
30	(c)	43	(b)
31	(d)	44	(b)
32	(b)	45	(b)
33	(c)	46	(c)
34	(b)	47	(b)
35	(b)	48	(b)
36	(b)	49	(c)
37	(c)	50	(c)
38	(b)		

PART C: PRACTICE QUESTIONS (51-75)

51. What is the prescribed fee for the 'Recall of Postal Articles' (reclaiming an article after posting but before delivery)?
- (a) Rs. 3/- (c) Rs. 9/-
(b) Rs. 6/- (d) Rs. 10/-
52. A Post Box is rented for a period commencing from the first day of the month in which it is allotted. The rental period is aligned with:
- (a) The Calendar Year (c) A period of 12 months from allotment
(b) The Financial Year (d) Any quarter of the year
53. If a parcel is redirected to an address served by a different Post Office, what is the redirection fee chargeable?
- (a) No fee (Free redirection) (c) Half the prepaid postage
(b) Full prepaid postage (d) One-fourth of the prepaid postage
54. Machine franked articles must be posted at:
- (a) Any Letter Box (c) Any Head Post Office
(b) Only at the counter of the specific Post Office mentioned in the licence (d) Any Post Office within the Circle
55. What is the maximum weight limit for a Book Packet containing printed books?
- (a) 2 Kg (c) 5 Kg
(b) 4 Kg (d) 10 Kg
56. The license fee for the 'Business Reply Service' is to be paid in advance. When is it due for renewal?
- (a) 1st January every year (c) Anniversary of the date of issue
(b) 1st April every year (d) 31st December every year

57. Currency notes can be sent by post only in Insured Letters. What is the maximum value limit for such currency notes?

- (a) Rs. 10,000/-
- (b) Rs. 20,000/-
- (c) Rs. 50,000/-
- (d) Rs. 1,00,000/-

58. Articles addressed to a deceased person are generally returned to the sender. However, they may be delivered to a near relative if:

- (a) The relative pays a fee of Rs. 10/-
- (b) The article is unregistered and no doubt exists regarding title/ownership
- (c) The article is insured
- (d) A court order is produced immediately

59. When a registered article is refused by the addressee, it is:

- (a) Kept in deposit for 7 days
- (b) Returned to sender immediately
- (c) Sent to the RLO (Returned Letter Office)
- (d) Opened by the Postmaster

60. What is the maximum weight of a Blind Literature Packet?

- (a) 5 Kg
- (b) 7 Kg
- (c) 10 Kg
- (d) 2 Kg

61. Which of the following articles is PROHIBITED from transmission by post?

- (a) Gold coins valued at Rs. 10,000/-
- (b) Any sharp instrument not properly protected
- (c) A lottery ticket authorized by the Government
- (d) Cultures of micro-organisms sent to a laboratory

62. What is the time limit for preferring a complaint regarding the miscarriage or loss of a Registered Letter?

- (a) 1 month from date of posting
- (b) 3 months from date of posting
- (c) 6 months from date of posting
- (d) 1 year from date of posting

63. The 'Window Delivery Ticket' is used for the identification of:

- (a) Any member of the public
- (b) Post Box holders only
- (c) The messenger of a firm/institution receiving registered mail
- (d) Government officials only

64. Insurance is mandatory for which of the following?

- (a) All parcels weighing above 5 Kg
- (b) Coin, bullion, platinum, precious stones, or jewellery
- (c) Any article sent to a government office
- (d) Passports sent by post

65. What is the fee for the alteration of the payee's name in a Money Order which has not yet left India?

- (a) Free of charge
- (b) Second commission equal to the first
- (c) Rs. 5/-
- (d) Rs. 10/-

66. The maximum value for which an article can be insured at a Branch Post Office (BO) is:

- (a) Rs. 500/-
- (b) Rs. 600/-
- (c) Rs. 10,000/-
- (d) Rs. 1,00,000/-

67. For an unregistered parcel, the maximum weight limit is:

- (a) 2 Kg
- (b) 4 Kg
- (c) 10 Kg
- (d) 20 Kg

68. A 'Poste Restante' article must bear which superscription to be accepted?

- (a) "To be kept till called for" or "Poste Restante"
- (b) "Urgent"
- (c) "Care of Postmaster"
- (d) "Identity Required"

69. If a Value Payable (VP) article is refused by the addressee, it is returned to the sender. What charges are recovered from the sender?
- (a) No charges (c) 50% of the postage
(b) The VP fee only (d) The return postage (if it was a parcel)
70. Who is the authority competent to grant a license for a Franking Machine to a private party?
- (a) The Postmaster of the local HPO (c) The Inspector of Posts
(b) The Divisional Head (Superintendent/SSPOs) (d) The Circle Head
71. Official Postal Articles must bear the superscription:
- (a) "On India Government Service" (c) "Official Mail"
(O.I.G.S.)
(b) "Service Paid" (d) "Government of India"
72. What is the prescribed handling charge for each article delivered under the 'Business Reply Service'?
- (a) Re. 1/- (c) Rs. 5/-
(b) Rs. 2/- (d) Rs. 10/-
73. Compensation paid by the Department for the loss of a Registered Article is:
- (a) Actual value of contents (c) 30 SDR
(b) Rs. 100/- (d) The amount of postage paid
74. Which of the following may NOT be enclosed in a Book Packet?
- (a) A written communication of the nature of a letter (c) Pictures and maps
(b) Complimentary slips (d) Printed notices

75. Post Boxes and Post Bags are available on rent at which type of Post Offices?

- (a) All Post Offices
- (b) Only Head Post Offices
- (c) Only determined by the Head of the Circle
- (d) All Departmental Sub Post Offices



ANSWER KEY (PART C)

Q.No	Answer	Q.No	Answer
51	(b)	64	(b)
52	(b)	65	(a)
53	(c)	66	(b)
54	(b)	67	(b)
55	(c)	68	(a)
56	(b)	69	(a)
57	(b)	70	(b)
58	(b)	71	(a)
59	(b)	72	(a)
60	(b)	73	(c)
61	(b)	74	(a)
62	(b)	75	(c)
63	(c)		